RE: Have a question on your Physical Sciences and Natural Sciences degrees

5 messages

admissions@mit.edu <admissions@mit.edu> 9 June 2024 at 14:17
To: tompiccolo50@gmail.com

Hello,

Thank you for reaching out; we've received your email.

We promise to get back to you as soon as we can, typically within 3-5 business days, and will answer all of your questions!

Thank you,
MIT Undergraduate Admissions

---

admissions@mit.edu <admissions@mit.edu> 13 June 2024 at 16:03
To: tompiccolo50@gmail.com

Hi Tom,

Thank you for reaching out to our office! We do not have any grade or GPA requirements for admission, though we do have recommendations. Because a strong foundation in math is so central, and we find prior familiarity with physics to be important for success, students should have math through calculus and at least one year of physics.

Students who are well matched with MIT take the following classes in high school:

- Math, through calculus
- One year or more of physics
- One year or more of chemistry
- One year or more of biology
- Four years of English
- Two years of a foreign language
- Two years of history and/or social sciences

In general, what you take should be based on your interests and aptitudes. That is, you should focus on taking the most challenging courses available to you in the areas that most interest you. We know that not all high schools offer the chance to take all these recommended classes, and we take this into consideration when reviewing your application.

I hope this information helps! If you need anything else, please let us know.

Best,
Mariel
MIT Admissions

From: "Tom Piccolo" <tompiccolo50@gmail.com>
Sent: Sunday, June 9, 2024 10:10:03 AM
To: admission@harvard.edu, admission@mit.edu

Hello
Do the high entry requirements for your STEM degree courses reflect the type of candidate required to be successful in that degree program? I.e if, at A Level you ask for A* in physics- you need an A* level understanding to do well on the degree course
Thanks
Tom

Tom Piccolo <tompiccolo50@gmail.com> 13 June 2024 at 16:42
To: admissions@mit.edu

Hello

Could I ask what your rationale is behind only admitting the top scorers in the SAT to MIT? Is it anything to do with academic ability? This is as per your statistics page.

Thanks

Tom
[Quoted text hidden]

---

admissions@mit.edu <admissions@mit.edu> 13 June 2024 at 16:50
To: tompiccolo50@gmail.com

[Quoted text hidden]

---

admissions@mit.edu <admissions@mit.edu> 14 June 2024 at 14:16
To: tompiccolo50@gmail.com

Hi Tom,

As mentioned on our statistics page, it's important to understand that the numbers there do not *determine* our admissions process, but are the *result of* our process. You can read full details here about why we require the SAT/ACT and how we consider scores, but this blog post in particular goes into depth about correlation vs. causation regarding admissions data and standardized test scores. In brief summary, what Admissions prefers are things which *may coincide* with higher SAT scores, but SAT scores themselves are not a determinative characteristic.

We hope this helps to answer your question!

Best,
Sam
[Quoted text hidden]